Worksheet W1 · W-Seminar "Time"

The seminar at a glance

Three semesters, one Seminararbeit. Keep this page in the front of your folder.

1 Your road to the Seminararbeit

12/1 now – Feb 2027

- **Test** – research methods
- **Topic fixed** – by the end of 12/1

12/2 Feb – Jul 2027

- **Presentation** – first look at your topic
- **Method** – design + first data

13/1 Sep – Nov 2027

- **Hand-in** – 2nd school day in Nov 2027
- **Prüfungsgespräch**

In our sessions we alternate between **methods** (searching, citing, surveys, experiments, statistics, writing) and **the topic itself** – the many dimensions of time.

2 How you are graded

12/1	Halbjahresleistung: test + smaller tasks	
12/2	Halbjahresleistung: presentation + smaller tasks	
13/1	**Seminararbeit**	counts **× 2**
	Prüfungsgespräch	counts **× 1**

Prüfungsgespräch: in our seminar group, led by me. You show that you really understand the content and methods of your paper – expect questions about your working process and how you used AI.

0 points in the Seminararbeit *or* the Prüfungsgespräch means: no admission to the Abitur.

3 The Seminararbeit in brief

- written **in English**, the Prüfungsgespräch too
- about **10–15 pages** of text (without title page, contents, works cited, appendix)
- you **put something to the test**: survey, experiment, measurement or systematic text analysis – and evaluate your own data
- sources cited in **MLA style**
- signed **declaration of authorship** + **AI log**
- format unless announced otherwise: 12 pt, line spacing 1.5, margins 2.5 cm
- internal point of reference: **5000 words**

4 AI, tools and your own voice

AI tools are part of real research – use them, but **openly**.

- Keep an **AI log**: date, tool, what you asked, what you used – *including language polishing*.
- Never trust an AI reference – check that every source exists.
- **Snapshots, about every 4 weeks:** hand in your current state – dump, outline or draft, however rough.
- **Planned:** a supervised writing session – if you want your language graded in full, the text you write there is your reference.

AI log – one line per use

date	12 Mar 2027
tool	chatbot / translator / …
task	"Suggest a clearer word order for §2"
used	3 sentences reworded, marked in the text

5 Start now

- ☐ Explore the dimensions of time on the website
- ☐ Set up a citation tool (e.g. Zotero) – save every source right away
- ☐ Start a research log: date · what I did · next step
- ☐ Note down every idea, however small
- ☐ Ask early – about topics, methods, sources
- ☐ Set up your **3-2-1 backup** – today (box 6)

6 Back up – every time you work

3	2	1
copies of your work	different media	in another place

e.g. laptop + USB stick or external drive + OneDrive

- **Sync is not a backup**: delete or overwrite a file in a synced folder and the mistake syncs too. Learn where the **version history** is (OneDrive, Overleaf).
- Save milestones as new versions: `2027-03-12_seminararbeit_v03.docx` – never just *final_final2.docx*.
- A lost file does not move the deadline.

My 3 copies: 1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____

Word is perfect for the dump and your first drafts. For the final paper you may want LaTeX (Overleaf, with Git built in) – we'll have a session on this and other tools such as Git and Kanban boards later.